

If you live this way, you are driving at the financial redline on a narrow road bordering a cliff. There is little hope for Sidewalkers because their roadmap is corrupted by gratification, selfishness, and irresponsibility. This problematic disposition repels wealth and thrusts codependency on overburdened hosts: taxpayers, employers, friends, parents, and loved ones. Income-Poor Sidewalkers rationalize, “Life is short. Get out of my way or get run over!”

SIDEWALKING SYMPTOMS: ARE YOU ON IT?

You haven’t learned much since graduating from high school or college.

“I’m done with school, hooray!”

You change jobs frequently.

“C’mon, MJ, I left because this other job pays more.”

You think people with money have it because they had rich parents, luck, or easier life circumstances than you.

“I’ve had it hard. If my parents would have paid for college I could have had a good job. I had a rough childhood. Those people with money have no idea.”

You are easily impressed and seek to impress.

“I love designer purses, German cars, Italian clothes, and purebred dogs. I work hard for my money and I deserve it!”

You have poor credit.

“I pay my obligations most of the time . . . it’s just that I can’t always pay on time because of situations outside of my control. Besides, the banks and utility companies are big, rich companies—they are the enemy.”

You put faith into politicians and government to change the system, instead of focusing on how you can change yourself.

“A bigger government is the solution. More regulation, more programs, and more services. The government should serve the people. Rich people should pay more in taxes for their good fortune—they can afford it and I can’t!”

You view pawnshops, payday loan stores, and credit cards as a means of supplemental income.

“Groceries can’t wait until the next paycheck—my family has to eat! Besides, there’s a sale on crab legs for only \$18 a pound.”

You have filed for bankruptcy at least once.

“It wasn’t my fault—I overextended myself and didn’t expect to lose my job. I didn’t